

DEFRA / DESNZ GHG Conversion Factors 2026
Major changes report (SYNTHETIC ? for testing only)

This document summarises the most significant changes to conversion factors for the 2026 update relative to 2025.

Change: Electricity generated

The UK grid average electricity factor increased by around 9%. The 2026 update reflects a higher share of natural gas generation in the 2024 generation mix used as the basis for the factor, together with a methodology refresh aligning transmission and distribution losses with the latest DUKES data.

Change: Diesel (average biofuel blend)

The diesel factor rose by about 6%. This reflects a reduction in the average biofuel content of forecourt diesel under the revised Renewable Transport Fuel Obligation blend for the reporting year, which raises the fossil carbon intensity per litre.

Change: Aluminium

Primary aluminium increased by roughly 14% following an update to the upstream electricity intensity used for smelting in the underlying life cycle inventory, reflecting a less decarbonised assumed power mix.